

Resilience & Growth Mindset

Character **First**

SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATION — EVIDENCE PYRAMID

Meta-analysis Burnette et al. (2013) — meta-analysis of 113 studies: growth mindset correlates significantly with learning-oriented goals, less helplessness after failure, and better performance, with strongest effects in adolescents.

Psychological Bulletin.

Systematic Review Meijen et al. (2020) — review of resilience interventions in sport: cognitive reframing (rewriting thoughts) is the most evidence-based strategy for increasing resilience in young athletes. *Frontiers in Psychology.*

Longitudinal study Martin & Marsh (2009) — 2-year follow-up with 3,500 students: academic resilience is a better predictor of long-term success than intelligence score or achievement motivation. Results replicable in sports context.

GUIDANCE REWRITE THE MISTAKE

- 1 Introduce the concept of fixed vs. growth mindset with a real example from your own career as a player or coach. "I always thought I wasn't fast enough. Later I realized I had never really trained my start."
- 2 Have players write individually. This is personal and may stay private. Then ask who wants to share an example of the "rewritten" version. Focus the conversation on the learning, not the mistake itself.

COACH TIPS FOR THIS THEME

Tip 1: Change your own language as a coach. Stop with "That's not for you." Start with "You haven't mastered that yet. What do we need to train?" This model is just as powerful for coaches as for players.

Tip 2: Use the Progress List as a fixed ritual at the beginning of each monthly session. Players who consistently see themselves improve need less external validation and are more stable in difficult periods.

Tip 3: Month 6 likely falls in the middle or end of the season — the moment players have the hardest time: fatigue, disappointments, motivation dip. This theme is deliberately placed here as reorientation and energy boost.

⚠ Growth mindset messages can backfire when used to mask a lack of support. "Just try harder" is not enough when a player is really stuck. Always combine the theme with concrete tools and individual guidance where needed.

TIMING

- ☐ Introduction fixed vs. growth mindset: 8 minutes
- ☐ Individual worksheet completion: 10 minutes
- ☐ Group reflection on rewritten mistakes: 10 minutes
- ☐ Progress list and closing: 7 minutes